

Pre-Colonial Administrative In Nigeria:

INDOORATION

Before the coming of Europeans into Nigeria, the various ethnic groups were autonomous and had developed their governmental systems in such a way that it deflected the cultural beliefs and traditions of the different areas. The three dominant ethnic groups comprising the Hausa-Fulani, the Igbo and Yoruba established distinct and functioning governments which were peculiar to their environment.

While the Hausa-Fulani empire established a centralised system of government deeply rooted in the Islamic religion, the Yoruba kingdom had a governmental system that provided for checks and balances on the organs of government. In a traditional political organization of the Igbo people provided as for centralised not semi-centralised government for there were many institutions showing political authority, sometimes with none having absolute power over members of the community.

THE HAUSA-FULANI

The Hausa-Fulani empire had its origin from the holy war (Jihad) of 1804 which began in Dan Fodio, a Fulani Muslim launched against the Hausa rulers of the period with a view to making Islam devoutly practised as the only religion in the land.

During this period, the Fulani people were under the domination of the Hausa. The deterioration of the then Hausa leadership made room for the establishment of an

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Empire Under the leadership of Altham Dan Fodio. Based on the two (2) main groups, the new empire became the Hausa-Fulani empire, though the leadership became dominated by the Fulani.

The newly established empire was divided into eastern and western sections, namely, the Sokoto and Gwandu emirates respectively. Each emirate was headed by an emir who was both spiritual and political leader.

The Emirs of Sokoto and Gwandu appointed emirs for the subordinate emirates; but of whatever the local people appointed emirs, such appointment was subject to the approval of the emirs of Sokoto and Gwandu. All other emirs paid annual tributes and allegiance to those of Sokoto and Gwandu with the Sultan of Sokoto being the overall head.

POLITICAL ORGANIZATION OF THE HAUSA-FULANI EMPIRE

The Political Organization of the Hausa-Fulani empire comprised of the following:-
1. THE EXECUTIVE:- The Emir was the spiritual, political and administrative head of the emirate. The government was based on the Islamic religion, culture and tradition. The combination of the functions of head of state, government and religious leader made him an absolute ruler in the administration of the emirate. He was assisted in the administration of the emirate by a number of officers whom he appointed. The officers were responsible to him and accountable to the emir only. Some of them were in advisory position to him, but he

Was not bound by such advice. The autocratic Powers of the Emirs were limited by the provisions of the Shar'ia, which is a guiding principle comprising the body of laws of the Islamic Religion. The Emirs secured obedience and compliance from the subjects as a result of the dominant influence of the Islamic Religion on the People.

B. ADMINISTRATIVE STRUCTURE: — The administrative functions of the Emirate were carried out by a number of officers appointed by the Emir to assist him. For instance: —

i. Mazari — Performed the function of advisor to the Emir and acted as Prime Minister of the Emirate.

ii. Galadima — Administrator of the Capital City of the Emirate.

iii. Sarkin Fada — Head of the Palace Mooters

iv. Magawaki — The Commander of the Army.

v. Sarkin Yankwa / Dogari — The Chief of the Police

vi. Maji — The Officer in charge of the treasury

vii. Sarkin Dawa — The Officer in charge of fishing and other related activities

or festivals.

viii. Sarkin Pawa — Officer in charge of the Butchers.

ix. Yori — Officers in charge of the Prisons.

The Emirate was divided into districts while the districts were further sub-divided into villages which again had wards. The districts were administered by district heads while, village heads controlled the machinery of government at the village levels as the head made did in their wards. The flow of

authority originated from the Emir to the district heads, the village heads and finally to the head heads. Appointments (and removals) were made in that order too, with village heads appointing head heads. The village heads collected taxes on land and cattle, part of which went to the Emir and the district heads.

THE LEGISLATURE: — The entire legislative process was based on the Islamic religion though the Sharia, and any contrary law was illegal. In areas where the Sharia was silent, the Emir made pronouncements which had the force of law. The Emir also delegated powers of making such laws to the districts and village heads who were answerable and loyal to him, even though such laws could be overruled. All extra-Sharia laws must not contradict any part of the Sharia. The legislature was a forum composed of the Emir, the Sharia law and the Council of Officers (elders) who were appointed and responsible to the Emir.

THE JUDICIARY: — The Judiciary was established in accordance with the Islamic religion. It was therefore based on the Sharia. The Sharia law deals with issues like Marriage, divorce, debt, inheritance, Slavery, Stealing, Murder and Custody of children. The Emir was the overall head of the Judiciary and presided over the Court of Appeal in his Palace. The Court handled Criminal cases and land disputes. Generally, Justice was administered by Aikalis who were well trained in the interpretation and application of the Sharia law and performed these functions in the Villages, district and Capital City, Presiding over all the Courts.

THE NATURE OF THE TRADITIONAL HAUSA-FOULANI SYSTEM OF GOVERNMENT

- a. The Emir had a council of advisers which he could not ignore.
- b. The administration was feudalistic, and not theocratic, not democratic.
- c. The Ghana described the basis of law, order and justice. (It was not arbitrary).
- d. There was rule of law in the Ghana jurisdiction.

2. Emulation developed among the Princes. PRE-COLONIAL ADMINISTRATION IN YORUBA LAND

1. THE YORUBA KINGDOM

The Yoruba People claim to have originated from Ile-Ife. The legend further states that Oduduwa, the father of the race, had seven sons who later became the first set of seven Yoruba Kings (Obas) to rule the various Yoruba Kingdoms. 2. Procreation and extension The number of kingdoms increased, each ruled by an Oba and with largely similar administrative structures. The Oba Kingdom had a well defined structure or representative of the pre-colonial political system of the Yoruba. 3. POLITICAL STRUCTURE OF THE YORUBA TRADITIONAL POLITICAL SYSTEM

The Yoruba Kingdom developed an efficient governmental system which existed for centuries before the coming of Europeans and balance in which the various organs of government checked the activities of one another to avoid dictatorship.

MAJOR ORGANS OF GOVERNMENT IN THE

YORUBA TRADITIONAL POLITICAL SYSTEM

1. THE OBA OR ALAFIN:— The Oba was the

Political, cultural and sometimes spiritual religious head of the Kingdom. In most cases, the Oba must be the eldest son of the deceased king and in any case, should belong to one of the royal families. The Oba was not an absolute ruler but had chiefs with whom he held consultations and both of whom served as checks and balances on each other. It was the Oba who appointed these chiefs following tradition. For example, by tradition some chieftaincy titles belonged to particular families or lineages who always had the right to fill such stools. Such families may propose one of them to the Oba for his ratification and appointment, or the Oba himself (consulting with his Council of chiefs), chose a member of the family he deemed fit.

The Oba with his chiefs exercised judicial powers especially over serious crimes, allocated land to people, settled land and other inter-ward disputes and gave to the general welfare of the people.

2. THE COUNCIL OF CHIEFS OR THE OYOMELE:-
The Council of chiefs (Oyomele) were also the Kingmakers. In Oyo, members were prominent chiefs drawn from seven notable wards that made up the capital city. The leader of the Council of chiefs in the Old Oyo Empire was the Bashorun, who also acted as the Prime Minister of the Kingdom. The seven Kingmakers acted as the Organ of checks and balances to the Powers and executives of the Oba. They were not only empowered to elect a new king at the demise of one, but also

to remove or impeach an Oba who violated the tradition of the community. The Chiefs as the Oba's advisers, met to discuss issues and took decisions which they presented to the Oba — who merely accepted such decisions / advice, but was not bound ~~by it~~ to accept. Such decisions and Orders by the Oba were then publicised as the 'Voice of the Oba' and then became law.

3. THE OGBONI FIDELITY: — The Ogboni Fidelity was one of the Political institutions of the Yoruba Kingdom. It was a Secret Society which comprised prominent elders and headed by the Oluro. The Fidelity checked the excesses of the Kingmakers in the area of determination of an Oba. They mediated between the Oba and the Kingmakers whenever there was a disagreement and performed rituals on behalf of the Kingdom.

4. THE AARE-ONAKARANFOS (War-General): — The Aare-Onakranfo was a Chief appointed by the Oba as a war general, to defend the territorial integrity of the Kingdom. The Constitution provided that an Aare-Onakranfo must Commit Suicide should the Kingdom suffer defeat in the battlefield. As a result, some Aare Onakranfos, go on exile in rivers, returned to the Kingdom after battle defeat, but established new settlements instead of committing suicide.

5. OTHER ORGANS OF THE GOVERNMENT:
PALACE OFFICIALS: — The Oba had the power to appoint some important officers who could carry out the administration of the Palace. They performed and supervised routine functions.

in the Palace, and in Oyo, were called ^{the} "Iwosefa".

b. VILLAGES AND WARD HEADS: — The Oba also approved the appointment of village heads called "Obale" and ward heads called "Mogric" to supervise their communities. The Village heads annually brought tributes and clues from their people to the Oba. Generally, there was no formal system of taxation among the Yoruba.

c. THE AGE-GRADSES: — There were groups of young men known around the same period. These were organized and given a name with defined leadership, and roles such as Police, Security, and general Maintenance of law and order, Environmental Sanitation, civic duties like building of Markets, roads and public buildings, joint Planting and harvesting and Mace hunting.

PRE-COLONIAL ADMINISTRATION IN IGBO LAND

POLITICAL ORGANIZATION OF IGBO LAND

As a result of the existence of many political institutions in Igboland, there was no centralization of power among the Igbo. Instead, Political institutions were performing similar or different functions. There were no topolitical offices in the form of Kings (as among the Yoruba and the Asa + Fulani) and so no hereditary claims to topolitical stools.

In their settings, there was never an Igbo Kingdom or an Ibo. The largest political unit was the village. The various institutions that exercised governmental powers included family heads, the Council of elders or the Ofo title holders, the age-grades, the

Or title holders as well as the lineage heads,

1. THE ~~THE~~ SYSTEM OF GOVERNMENT

VILLAGE ADMINISTRATION — The Village administration was made up of lineholders who

had Patrilineal or Patrilineal called Ummu. One of the Major Political institutions that controlled the affairs of Villages was the Council of elders which comprised heads of families that held staff of authority called U title holders. The elders headed their respective extended families and the most senior member of the Council of elders was chosen as the Okpara. The Okpara was also chosen from the eldest family in the village. The governmental system was republican because it was for those that could attain the required age. The Okpara lacked real executive power and merely presided over the Council of elders meeting and his influence on the Council of elders depended on his ability to provide qualitative leadership.

The Council had no authority to enforce decisions and compel obedience from their people but still handled matters regarding tradition, rituals and custom while more important issues that affected the whole village were referred to the village assembly.

2. THE VILLAGE ASSEMBLY

It was a meeting point of all adult males in the community. The meetings were held at the Obi or Palace of Okpara or Obi, or at the village square, where every adult male had the right to air his views on any issue under discussion, and decisions were reached

though consensus of the people in attendance the meeting was presided over by the Okpasa the Political institutions that often attended such meetings were the Council of elders, the age-grades and the Oso titleholders.

3. THE JUDICIAL: — Judicial functions were performed by the Council of elders and the entire village assembly. In the case of separation of Povoos between the Ogoone of government, and all the institutions participated in the enactment and interpretation of laws to the Society. Minor cases were settled by the family heads, while complicated cases were referred to the Council of elders and the Village assembly for determination.

4. AGE-GRADE SOCIETIES: — One of the traditional political institutions in Igbo land was the age-grade societies. The age-grades consisted of young men divided into numerous groups according to their ages. Each age-grade had a leader who coordinated the activities of the group.

They performed functions such as maintenance of law and order, arrest of offenders and implementation of judgments pronounced by the Council of elders and the entire village assembly. In addition, they mobilised young men for the defence of their territories, maintained security check points, cleared bush paths and performed environmental sanitation.

5. THE HOLDERS: — In some areas of Igbo land the traditional Political Organization also consisted of titleholders. The titleholders acquired by very wealthy, honest and forward

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Wooten) Members of the Society who were highly respected. The highest of all these titles was the Ozo. The obligation of the title holders to the Society included settlement of land disputes and Ozo guroo (s). They also enjoyed some social privilege in the Community. The Ozo sometimes wielded greater power than the elders council.

NATIONALISM

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Nationalism is the recognition by people in a common geographical setting that, they together belong to a nation with some common history, interests and goals and the need to free themselves from any socio-economic or political domination by other nations.

Nationalism is an act of political consciousness or state of mind primarily concerned with achieving the independence of the country from foreign rule. Nationalism can be defined as the strong emotional consciousness of belonging to a nation - state held in bondage by foreign domination which leads to the struggle against such foreign rule and elimination.

FACTORS THAT INFLUENCED THE EMERGENCE OF NATIONALISM IN NIGERIA

1. Emergence of Political Parties — The emergence and growth of political parties like NNDP, NCNC, AG (later led by Nwoye) and Politicians like Abacha, Awolowo, Arinze, Macaulay, etc, organised and spread the spirit of nationalism in Nigeria.
2. Economic exploitation by foreigners — The move - Policy of force in West Africa by European Multinational Companies and its attendant economic exploitation gave rise to the growth of nationalism and the desire of Africans to participate in the running and control of their own economy.
3. Racial discrimination — The racial discrimination in the civil service practised by the colonial rulers gave impetus to the growth of nationalism in Nigeria.
4. The Influence of Religion — The activities of Christian Missionaries that disorganised African

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- fractition and Culture played a very significant role in the rise of nationalism in Nigeria.
5. Growth and Development of Trade Unionism — The growth of trade unions in West Africa was synchronous with the rise of nationalism because the unions used the adoption of specific measures as a means of fighting for equal treatment in employment and better conditions of service. The respective of race, colour, creed and sex.
6. The Role of the Media — The emergence of Mass Media especially newspapers as African owned presses and news papers such as the West African Pilot, the high tide of criticisms of colonialism played an important role in the ~~process~~ of igniting nationalism.
7. Experience of the two world wars — The first and second world wars demonstrated the selfishness and the participation of Africans in the wars made them to realize that the whites were not inimical to Africans. and were in no way superior to Africans.
8. The Independence of some countries — The independence of India in 1947 and Ghana in 1957 encouraged the rise of nationalism and spread an Africanist attitude to increase the production.
9. The Emergence of Super powers — The second world war established USA and USSR as the most powerful nations in the world. The rise and fall of super powers encouraged European colonialism and imperialism in all its ramifications. The condemnation acted as a Moral booster to the growth of nationalism in West Africa.

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10 The Paris Declaration of the Atlantic Charter - the declaration in Article 3 of the Atlantic Charter in 1941 of the rights of all people to choose the form of government under which they will live and whose interests no nation must act in defiance -

HISTORICAL DEVELOPMENT OF NIGERIAN CONSTITUTION

The historical development of Constitution in Nigeria or the process of Constitution-making is characterised by identifiable phases with each phase representing certain Constitutional developments leading to gradual involvement of Nigerians in their own affairs. For easy identification the various constitutions of Nigeria up to the time of Independence are as follows.

THE PRE-1922 CONSTITUTIONS

Nigeria came into being on the 1st of January, 1914 when the two separate colonies and Southern Protectorate was amalgamated with the Northern Protectorate. Nigeria was administered by —

A Governor

Two Lieutenant Governors and an administrator of the Colony, and an Executive Council.

The Nigerian Council, dominated by official members with only advisory and deliberative roles. Lagos colony had its own legislative Council, Nationalists demanded for representative legislature in Western Nigeria and the Colonial govt in London. Pressures came from the National Congress of British West Africa (NCBA), local newspapers and some local individuals in the 21st century, particularly Lagos.

THE CLIFFORD CONSTITUTION OF 1922

The Constitution has the following features:

- The Political division of the country into the Colony and Northern and Southern Provinces each with a Lieutenant Governor.

An Executive Council for the whole of the Colony and Protectorate of Nigeria.

III A legislative Council which was intended to make laws for the maintenance of peace, Order and good government in the colony, and Southern Provinces of the Protectorate. Its authority was not extended to the Northern Provinces. Four of the unofficial members were to be selected — three to be present Lagos and one to represent Calabar area.

IV The Governor by Ordinance was to provide for the administration of justice, raising revenue and in general for the peace, Order and good govt. of the Northern Provinces.

V The Governor was empowered by the Constitution at his own discretion to apply to the Northern Provinces any Ordinance passed by the legislative Council. This provision however, did not confer any authority on the legislative Council to make laws applying to the Northern Provinces.

VI The Constitution stipulated disciplinary and income qualifications for the electors.

VII Mandated demerits became part of Nigeria.

VIII Spread of indirect rule system to the Southern Provinces.

THE RATTAS CONSTITUTION OF 1946

The new Constitution was announced in March, 1945 and came into force in 1946. Nigeria by this time had become politically active through the activities of the new generation of nationalists supported by an alert nationalist press, active trade union leaders and the emergence of a Modern Political Party, the NCNC.

FEATURES

i. The administrative division of Nigeria into

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three (3) regions — North, West and East, each under a Chief Commissioner (bearing the title Lieutenant Governor).

ii An Executive Council of Officials to assist the Governor.

iii A Legislative Council dominated by unofficial nominees of the Governor. The four (4) representatives of Lagos and Calabar remained to be elected.

iv A bicameral legislature in the North consisting of a House of Assembly and a House of Chiefs, and a unicameral legislature, i.e., the House of Assembly in each of the other two regions of West and East.

v Regional Assemblies were to function as electoral colleges for the indirect election of members of the legislative Council.

vi In the North, the House of Chiefs was presided over by the Chief Commissioner, while the House of Assembly was presided over by the Senior President. In both the East and West, the Chief Commissioner presided over each Region's House of Assembly.

The Constitution did not list more than two (2) powers as a result of complaints that the Constitution was undemocratic, Nations were not consulted and the Constitution was not publicly debated before it was drawn up and that the legislative Council was not even consulted before its formal presentation in the Council.

The new Governor Sir John MacPherson announced the Plan for Constitutional reform. He learnt from the criticism of the past constitutions by Mr. King

the Madras Participation through Preliminary Consultations of his Proposals at the Village, District, Provincial, Regional and Central Levels. The Constitution was finally drawn up and approved by the Legislative Council in 1950 and became operative in 1951.

THE MADRAS CONSTITUTION OF 1951

I A Central Legislature and a Central Executive were established.

II The Unicameral Legislature (called the House of Representatives) were indirectly elected from the Houses of Assembly in the Regions.

III The Executive (called the Council of Ministers) consisted of the Governor as President and twelve (12) Ministers and six (6) ex-officio Members.

IV Each region appointed four (4) Ministers, the Governor and Lieutenant Governor and approved by the Governor to serve in the Council of Ministers.

V A Lieutenant Governor administered each of the Regions.

VI Each region had a Legislature and an Executive Council.

VII The Northern and Madras Regions had a bicameral Legislature - a House of Assembly and a House of Chiefs, the Eastern Legislature was unicameral with only a House of Assembly.

VIII Members of the Houses of Assembly - North, West and East were indirectly elected with the divisional Councils, ~~Native~~ Native Authorities and the Provinces as the electoral Colleges.

IX The Regional Houses could legislate on limited areas such as agriculture, education, local

Government and Public health. The Central Legislature could legislate on all including areas listed for the regional legislature. Moreover, the Principle of Central Supremacy was provided in the constitution.

ix A Public Service Commission was created to advise the Governor on the appointment, promotion, dismissal and discipline of Public Servants in a unified Public Service system.

FACED THAT LED TO THE FALL OF THE MACDONALDSON CONSTITUTION

i. The Eastern Regional Councils of 1953 which was an NCNC intra-party feud led to the premature dissolution of the Eastern Region House of Assembly.

ii. The Motion of "Self Government" tabled in 1953 by Chief Anthony Enahoro an Action Group member in the House of Representatives, for Nigeria to attain self rule in 1956. The Northerners rejected the motion which led to the resignation of the ~~AGF~~ Action Group Ministers at the Central Executive. The NCNC supported the motion.

iii. The humiliation suffered by Northerners in Lagos following the rejection of the 'Self Government' Motion.

iv. The threat of Northern Secession by Northern Peoples Congress (NPC) following the crisis and the humiliation suffered.

v. The Kanriot of 1953 where the Northerners showed the resentment of Lagos incidents at an Action Group Political rally.

THE LITTLETON CONSTITUTION OF 1954

Two Constitutional Conferences were held in London in 1953 and in Lagos in 1954 under the Chairman -

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ship of the Secretary of State for the Colonies, then Oliver Lyttelton. A new Constitution emerged with the following.

FEATURES

- I. It introduced federalism into Nigeria —
 - a. the federal govt. legislated on 'Exclusive List'
 - b. each region exercised legislative and executive powers over its jurisdiction (or over 'residual subjects')
- II. Both the federal govt and the regions legislated on Concurrent list and when there is conflict between the two levels of government, federal govt. prevails.
- III. Creation of the federal Capital Territory of Lagos.
 - a. Southern Cameroons transfer of Assembly was completed, taking the Cameroons out of the Eastern region.
- IV. A Unilateral Legislature — in the case of Dependent territories had direct authority over Lagos Territory. A Minister for Lagos Affairs was appointed.
- V. Members of federal and regional houses were directly elected.
- VI. The Public Service was regionalized under separate federal and regional Public Service Commissions.
- VII. The Judiciary was also regionalized.
- VIII. The Principle of Devolution was adopted as the basis for revenue allocation.

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NIGERIA'S POLITICAL PARTIES MAINLY THE FINE REPUBLIC (1960-1966)

One peculiar feature of the development of Political Parties in Nigeria is that the pre-existing tribal and cultural associations, groups, guilds, unions, religious bodies, etc. were acted as spring boards for the formation of Political Parties in Nigeria. Formation of Political Parties in Nigeria the last had since the colonial era adopted a Multi-Party system was followed the for parties nature of Nigerian Federation.

During the first Republic (1960-1966), Nigeria adopted a Multi-Party System, a situation whereby many Political Parties competed for Power. The Parties were divided into two groups - Major Political Parties and Minor Political Parties.

Major Political Parties

1. Northern People's Congress (NPC)
National Council of Nigeria and the Cameroons (NCNC)

2. The Action Group (AG)

Minority Peoples Congress (MPC)

The Northern People's Congress (NPC) was founded in October 1951. NPC metamorphosed from the Northern Cultural Organization known as 'Omijoyos' Movement. Action Group founded in December 1949. The Party NPC was dominated by the Hausa - Fulanis. Its leader was Late Sir Ahmadu Bello, the Sardauna of Sokoto, a Powerful Spiritual and traditional leader.

The Party established absolute Political Control in the North and had automatic Northern's allegiance as a result of its strong tradition of

Obedience to Islam and support of traditional values -

Aims and Objectives

1. To foster the autonomy of the North
2. To contribute to the social, political and economic development of the North.
3. To redress the wrongs on the political and civil disabilities.
4. To foster co-operation and understanding amongst the Northerners, etc.

Attainment of Objectives

1. The first Nigerian Prime Minister emerged from NPC in 1959.
2. The Party controlled the Federal Government until 1966 when the Army took over the government.
3. The NPC controlled the Politics and government of Northern Region till 1966.
4. The Party represented Northern Region in all the Constitutional Conferences.
5. It fostered co-operation and understanding amongst the Northerners with the slogan "Our North Our People".

The National Council of Nigeria and the Cameroons (NCNC)

The NCNC was formed in August 1944. It was first named National Council of Nigeria and the Cameroons and later renamed the National Convention of Nigerian Citizens in 1960 when the Cameroons broke away from Nigeria. The NCNC was the first African Political Party to be organised to seed total independence for Nigeria. Late Herbert Macaulay was the first leader and President of NCNC and Dr. Nnamdi Azikiwe the Secretary-General.

Dr. Azikiwe eventually became the President of the Party after the passing away of Macaulay in 1948.

Aims and Objectives of NND

1. To achieve self-government for Nigeria.
2. To spread Political education to the people.
3. To ensure the Political Consciousness of the masses.
4. To establish a Platform as a medium of expression in order to achieve social equality, economic security, religious tolerance, etc.
5. ATTENTION MERIT / CONSIDERATIONS
The NND and the organ the West African Pilot launched their Political muscles to the general strike of 1945.
6. The Party played the role of uniting the Nigerian Nationalists in the fight for self-government for Nigeria.
7. The Political education helped to raise the Political Consciousness of the people of Nigeria.
8. The Party played significant role at the Constitutional Conference that led to the independence of Nigeria.
9. The NND formed the first regional government of Eastern Region and contributed greatly to its development.
10. It formed coalition government with the NPC in 1960 and produced the first President.

The Action Group (AG)

The Action Group (AG) was formally formed in March 1951 through the conversion of the Egbe Omo Oduduwa — a Yoruba Cultural Organisation founded in 1945 in London by some Yoruba Students studying there. Late Chief

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Obafemi Awolowo was the founder and leader of Action Group (AG).

Aims and Objectives of Action Group

- 1 To Contest, win elections and control Western Region.
- 2 To challenge the political dominance of the NCNC.
- 3 To co-operate and labour with other nationalists towards the achievement of immediate self-government for Nigeria.
- 4 To co-operate and strengthen all federal organizations in the Western Region.
- 5 ATTACHMENT 1 / CONTINUATIONS
Action Group formed the Opposition Party in the House of Representatives which played the role of a watchdog.
- 2 The Party contested and won elections in the Western Region and made every effort to develop the region.
- 3 AG introduced free primary education in the Western Region in 1955.
- 4 The Party played significant roles in the Nationalist Struggle for the independence of Nigeria.
- 5 Western Region was represented by AG in the various Constitutional Conference for the independence of Nigeria.
- 6 The Party (AG) wielded off seasons agitations for the independence of Nigeria by sponsoring the 1953 motion for the independence of Nigeria in 1956.

MINOR OR SMALLER POLITICAL PARTIES OF THE FIRST REPUBLIC

The Nigerian Multi-Party System of the First or 1st Republic gave rise to the emergence of many Political Parties apart from the three (3) major parties discussed above. Some of these smaller parties were splinter political parties formed as a result of disagreement that arose in the major parties.

One of the minor political parties formed in the first republic was the Northern Element Progressive Union (NEPU) - NEPU that was both radical and democratic, formed in August 1950 was led by Late Mallam Aminu Kano. Another party, the United Middle Belt Congress (UMBC) led by Late J. S. Igarua founded in 1955 consolidated its political activities in the Middle Belt and demanded for the creation of a Middle Belt region out of the Northern region.

The United National Independent Party (UNIP) led by Mr. Eyo Ita was a splinter party from NCNC and had co-operation with Action Group.

Other minor and splinter political parties formed and operated in the first republic included Prof Chikwe Obi - led Dynamic Party (DP), the Niger Delta Congress (NDC), the Lagos United Front (LUF), New Nigerian Democratic Party (NNDP) led by Chief Samuel L. Akinola, Boyo Youth Movement (BYM), etc.

POLITICAL PARTY ALLIANCES OF THE FIRST REPUBLIC (1960-1966)

The Political Parties that operated in Nigeria's first republic in spite of their differences had some forms of co-operation that existed

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between them. They co-operated effectively for the total Political emancipation of Nigeria from colonial administration.

This 2nd District of co-operation was clearly manifested after the 1954 elections when NPPe that won 79 seats in the North formed a coalition government in the Centre with the NCNC that won 65 seats in the East and West. While the AG that won 87 seats formed the Opposition and created an atmosphere of mutual confidence with which a formal motion for Nigeria's independence was unanimously passed in 1959. This led to Nigeria's independence on October 1, 1960.

The 3rd District with which ~~the~~ these Political Parties fought colonialism did not die completely after the achievement of independence. The political co-operation forced a new line in 1964 when all the main Political Parties that were winning 2/3 for the 1964 federal elections formed two alliances.

→ The first Alliance was called the Nigerian National Alliance (NNA) under the leadership of the late Sir Ahmadu Bello, the Governor of Sokoto and then Premier of Northern Region. The NNA comprised of the NPC-Northern Peoples Congress, the New Nigerian Democratic Party (NNDP), the Middle Belt Democratic Front (MBDF), Dynamic Party (DP) and Lagos United Front (LUF).

→ The second Alliance was the United Progressive Grand Alliance (UPGA) led by Dr. Michael O. Ojo, then Premier of Eastern Region. It was made up of the National Council of Nigeria and

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the Cameroons (NENC), the Action Group (AG), the Northern Element Progressive Union (NEPU) and the United Middle Belt Congress (UMBC). In 1964 federal elections were therefore contested by the two political alliances under various associations and counters-associations of election malpractices.

Under the charged atmosphere, Allie Abubakar Tafawa Balewa of the NPC lost seven more seats than the counterpart of ZPPGA, was invited to form the government. He was still tinkering with his dismissed board of government of government of National Unity when the Army in the early hours of January 15, 1966 took over government in a blood coup d'état, thereby, bringing to an end these two (2) grand opposing political groupings or alliances and their political activities to Lucasarmone and.

PROBLEMS OF PRE AND POST-INDEPENDENCE POLITICAL PARTIES IN NIGERIA.

1. The Political Parties were without national outlook. They had regional support and ethnic loyalty.

2. The Political Parties placed much emphasis on personal politics rather than issues. The parties were formed by few ethnic leaders.

3. Inter-party and intra-party conflicts in most cases polarised the political parties and splitting them into factions.

4. Coup d'état - Crossing the Movement from one Political Party to the other, is a phenomenon that has weakened or led to the collapse of the Political Parties.

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FACTORS THAT LED TO THE COLLAPSE OF FALL OF THE FIRST REPUBLIC (1960-1966)

The following are the contributing factors that led to the fall or collapse of the First Republic (1960-1966).

1. Party Politics: — Politics was played mainly by regional parties. Although smaller parties existed, the big-party sectional and ethnic politics were more influential. Little attempt was made in the formation of political parties that were national in outlook. The implication was that politics of ethnicity, tribalism, Moslem and Christian was encouraged and nurtured.

2. THE COLONIAL LEGACY: — Essentially, the first Republic failed because of the manner the British misruled the Nigerian nation. Colonialism and neo-colonialism largely limited on what independence could achieve. The economic, education, culture and politics of the people had been bastardized and notion of divide and rule became the major tenet of colonial rule. In fact, Nigerians grew up to hate themselves.

3. THE CONSTITUTIONAL FACTOR: — Certain aspects of the constitution were exploited by politicians for very narrow ends. The powers given to the regions became a threat to the federal system. These regions and the politicians which represented them, engaged in bitter struggles.

Several aspects of the constitution

were still alien to the country. We are based on the experiences of the APC and not the conditions in Nigeria and these were counter productive to our national progress.

4. Ethnicity: — Ethnicity or sometimes called tribalism was another cause of our fall of our First Republic. Politicians struggled to defend their regions and did not care much for the positive development of others and the Centre.

There were also problems with the regions because of the domination of Majority. Minority groups struggled with the large ones and often complained of neglect and discrimination.

5. COALITION GOVERNMENT: — Coalition in Government equally helped to the fall of the First Republic. The absence of a party with a national outlook, plus the fact that none of the parties was able to gain clearcut majority when elections were held, led to an unstable federal Government.

The APC had to enter into a Partnership with the NCC to be able to form a Coalition Government. The implication was loyalty. There were also the problem of the combined to weaken the government. 6. SECTIONALISM AND PATRIOTISM: — The sectionalism and patriotism led to corruption. Many were less concerned in the entire system. Nations did not

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see the Country as a nation. Many were more concerned with what the Army would benefit them what they would contribute for the development of Nigeria.

As a result, Corruption became rampant as each in dividual wanted what would benefit him or her and not what would promote the well being of Nigeria.

7. THE 1962-1963 CENSUS RESULTS:—1962-63 census series showed regional disparities. The census results gave the North a voting force that was big enough to dominate the Federal Parliament. Both AG and the NCNC had hoped that the census would change the representation of the regions.

When the result was announced in July 1962 the figures were likely to have been manipulated the results had to be cancelled, following the controversies which they generated.

A fresh census was conducted in 1963 which did not enjoy a unanimous approval. The census crisis left a bitterness among the regions and further deepened the already bad state of affairs.

8. THE 1964 FEDERAL ELECTIONS:—The elections were the first to be conducted after independence. The NPC needed the elections to consolidate its power at the Centre. The AG wanted to dislodge a Chief Akintola from power in the West. While the NCNC had to improve its bargaining strength.

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Two Main Coalitions contested the elections, the Nigerian National Alliance (NNA) made up of the NPC and some Minor parties and the 2 United Progressive and Alliance (2UPGA). The elections were much bitterness and violence especially in the West.

In elections where organized electoral officers were harassed and candidates whose returned and posed them in constituencies where it was clear that they would never win. The NCC on its own prevented elections in the East.

In spite of those irregularities, the Federal Electoral Commission (FEC) announced results and the President Late Dr Nnamdi Azikiwe, in accordance with the constitutional invited late Sir Abubakar Tafawa Balewa to form the government.

The elections revealed the fragility of the Republic. Tensions, conflicts and controversies marked the era. It was not surprising that disasters followed. WESTERN DEGRADATION: In the Western Region, the Action Group (AG) encountered a crisis which led to a split within its rank and left the West in great turmoil throughout the first Republic. The rift within the Action Group led to clashes in Parliament.

Insurgencies emerged in Anambra and Akintola groups. The causes of the conflict were ideological and personal. Following the clash, the Federal Government intervened it dissolved the

Western Region House of Assembly. Sus-
 pended the Governor and declared a
 State of Emergency. Chief Majeedun-
 mi was the appointed Solicitor General
 for six (6) months.

10. Another factor that led to the fall of
 the first Ok Public was the attempt to
 discredit Chief Obafemi Awolowo
 through the cover commission of Enquiry.
 He was arrested in November 1962 and
 charged with treason. In June 1963, he
 was sentenced to jail for ten (10) years.
 The jail term on Awolowo frustrated
 his ~~and~~ to create bitterness in some
 sections of the nation.